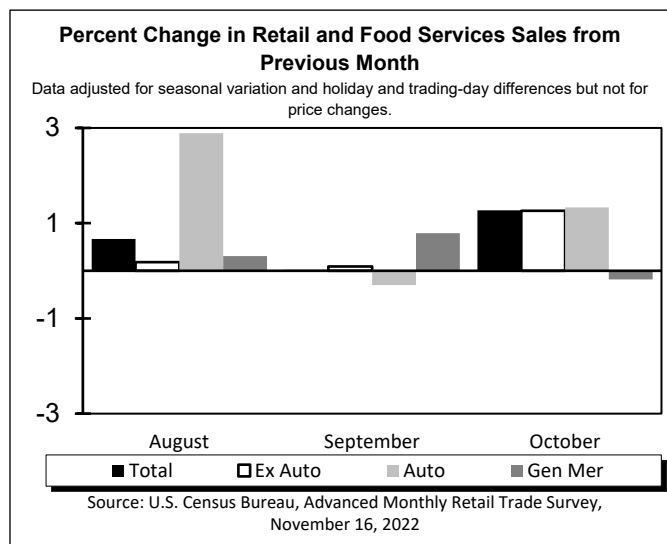


ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES FOR RETAIL AND FOOD SERVICES, OCTOBER 2022

Release Number: CB22-184

November 16, 2022 — The U.S. Census Bureau announced the following advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for October 2022:

ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES		
October 2022	\$694.5 billion	1.3%
September 2022 (revised)	\$685.8 billion	0.0%*
Next release: December 15, 2022		
* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero. Data adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences but not for price changes. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advanced Monthly Retail Trade Survey, November 16, 2022		



Advance Estimates of U.S. Retail and Food Services

Advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for October 2022, adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences, but not for price changes, were \$694.5 billion, up 1.3 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the previous month, and 8.3 percent (± 0.7 percent) above October 2021. Total sales for the August 2022 through October 2022 period were up 8.9 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the same period a year ago. The August 2022 to September 2022 percent change was unrevised from virtually unchanged (± 0.2 percent)*.

Retail trade sales were up 1.2 percent (± 0.5 percent) from September 2022, and up 7.5 percent (± 0.7 percent) above last year. Gasoline stations were up 17.8 percent (± 1.6 percent) from October 2021, while food services and drinking places were up 14.1 percent (± 3.2 percent) from last year.

General Information

The November 2022 Advance Monthly Retail report is scheduled for release on December 15, 2022 at 8:30 a.m. EST. View the full schedule in the Economic Briefing Room: <<https://www.census.gov/economic-indicators/>>. The full text and tables of this release can be found at <www.census.gov/retail/>.

Data Inquiries

Economic Indicators Division, Retail Indicator Branch
301-763-2713
eid.retail.indicator.branch@census.gov

Media Inquiries

Public Information Office
301-763-3030
pio@census.gov

Special Notice

Beginning with the December 15, 2022 release for the November 2022 data, the estimates will be based on a new sample. For further information on the sample revision, see our website at [<https://www.census.gov/retail/marts_sample_revision_faqs.html>](https://www.census.gov/retail/marts_sample_revision_faqs.html).

EXPLANATORY NOTES

The advance estimates are based on a subsample of the Census Bureau's full retail and food services sample. A stratified random sampling method is used to select approximately 5,500 retail and food services firms whose sales are then weighted and benchmarked to represent the complete universe of over three million retail and food services firms.

Survey Description

The U.S. Census Bureau conducts the Advance Monthly Retail Trade and Food Services Survey to provide an early estimate of monthly sales by kind of business for retail and food service firms located in the United States. Each month, questionnaires are mailed to a probability sample of approximately 5,500 employer firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey. Advance sales estimates are computed using a link relative estimator. For each detailed industry, we compute a ratio of current-to-previous month weighted sales using data from units for which we have obtained usable responses for both the current and previous month. For each detailed industry, the advance total sales estimates for the current month is computed by multiplying this ratio by the preliminary sales estimate for the previous month (derived from the larger MRTS) at the appropriate industry level. Total estimates for broader industries are computed as the sum of the detailed industry estimates. The link relative estimate is used because imputation is not performed for most nonrespondents in MARTS. For a limited number of nonresponding companies that have influential effects on the estimates, sales may be estimated based on historical performance of that company. The monthly estimates are benchmarked to the annual survey estimates from the Annual Retail Trade Survey once available. The estimates are adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading day differences. Additional information on MARTS and MRTS can be found on the Census Bureau website at: [<www.census.gov/retail>](http://www.census.gov/retail).

Reliability of Estimates

Because the estimates presented in this report are based on a sample survey, they contain sampling error and nonsampling error.

Sampling error is the difference between the estimate and the result that would be obtained from a complete enumeration of the sampling frame conducted under the same survey conditions. This error occurs because only a subset of the entire sampling frame is measured in a sample survey. Standard errors

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and coefficients of variation (CV), as given in Table 3 of this report, are estimated measures of sampling variation.

The margin of sampling error, as used on page 1, gives a range about the estimate which is a 90 percent confidence interval. If, for example, the percent change estimate is +1.2 percent and its estimated standard error is 0.9 percent, then the margin of sampling error is $\pm 1.753 \times 0.9$ percent or ± 1.6 percent, and the 90 percent confidence interval is -0.4 percent to +2.8 percent. If the interval contains 0, then one does not have sufficient evidence to conclude at the 90 percent confidence level that the change is different from zero and therefore the change is not statistically significant. Estimated changes shown in the text are statistically significant unless otherwise noted. For a monthly total, the median estimated coefficient of variation is given. The resulting confidence interval is the estimated value $\pm 1.753 \times CV \times$ (the estimated monthly total). The Census Bureau recommends that individuals using estimates in this report incorporate this information into their analyses, as sampling error could affect the conclusions drawn from the estimates.

Nonsampling error encompasses all other factors that contribute to the total error of a sample survey estimate. This type of error can occur because of nonresponse, insufficient coverage of the universe of retail businesses, mistakes in the recording and coding of data, and other errors of collection, response, coverage, or processing. Although nonsampling error is not measured directly, the Census Bureau employs quality control procedures throughout the process to minimize this type of error.

Statement Regarding COVID-19 Impact

The Census Bureau continues to monitor response and data quality and has determined that estimates in this release meet publication standards. For more information, see [COVID-19 FAQs](#).

Weather Information

For information on the impact of weather events on the compilation of this report, please see the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) on our website at:

[<www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faqs.html>](http://www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faqs.html)

RESOURCES

The Rest of the Consumer Spending Story

Retail and services together represent what's commonly referred to as consumer spending. Quarterly Services Survey (QSS) revenue comprises roughly 2/3 of the personal consumption expenditures component of the U.S. Gross Domestic Product (GDP) measured by the Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA).

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The third quarter 2022 Advance Quarterly Services Report will be available on November 18, 2021 at 10:00 AM. Learn about historical revenue trends for certain industries going back 15 years and other data, such as in-patient days and discharges for hospitals, by visiting <<https://www.census.gov/services/index.html>>

API

The Census Bureau's application programming interface lets developers create custom apps to reach new users and makes key demographic, socio-economic and housing statistics more accessible than ever before. <www.census.gov/developers/>

FRED Mobile App



Receive the latest updates on the nation's key economic indicators by downloading the FRED App <<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/fred-mobile/>> for both Apple and Android devices. FRED, the signature database of the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, now incorporates the Census Bureau's 13 economic indicators.

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* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero.

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Table 1. Estimated Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Total sales estimates are shown in millions of dollars and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS ¹ code	Kind of Business	Not Adjusted							Adjusted ²				
		10 Month Total		2022			2021		2022			2021	
		2022	% Chg. 2021	Oct. ³ (a)	Sep. (p)	Aug. (r)	Oct.	Sep.	Oct. ³ (a)	Sep. (p)	Aug. (r)	Oct. (r)	Sep. (r)
	Retail & food services,												
	total	6,678,337	9.9	688,177	664,134	702,729	638,069	609,406	694,518	685,794	685,685	641,459	631,563
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts) ...	5,391,522	11.6	562,316	539,254	566,838	517,883	490,752	565,057	558,030	557,536	518,451	510,471
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	6,034,112	7.8	623,891	602,321	634,752	583,335	557,412	630,424	624,227	621,737	587,051	579,776
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	4,747,297	9.0	498,030	477,441	498,861	463,149	438,758	500,963	496,463	493,588	464,043	458,684
	Retail	5,828,963	8.9	597,492	576,853	613,416	557,737	532,840	604,997	597,720	598,380	563,010	553,275
	GAFO⁴	(*)	(*)	(*)	120,896	129,182	125,223	116,392	(*)	127,833	127,287	125,978	124,377
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1,286,815	3.6	125,861	124,880	135,891	120,186	118,654	129,461	127,764	128,149	123,008	121,092
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers .	1,182,989	3.0	115,010	114,158	124,722	110,342	109,222	118,812	117,085	117,662	113,404	111,679
44111	New car dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	91,709	99,049	87,437	86,553	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4413	Auto parts, acc. & tire stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	10,722	11,169	9,844	9,432	(*)	10,679	10,487	9,604	9,413
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	118,313	1.6	11,968	12,065	12,534	12,040	11,974	12,113	11,981	12,087	12,064	11,962
4421	Furniture stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,709	6,778	6,629	6,614	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4422	Home furnishings stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
443	Electronics & appliance stores	69,988	-6.4	6,925	6,901	7,224	7,896	7,548	7,367	7,389	7,387	8,382	8,081
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	430,516	7.6	43,038	42,586	45,165	39,435	38,859	43,719	43,246	43,314	40,040	39,261
4441	Building mat. & sup. dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	37,488	39,905	34,618	34,340	(*)	37,563	37,646	34,932	34,306
445	Food & beverage stores.....	776,784	7.6	80,959	78,215	80,093	75,780	72,978	81,038	79,888	79,317	75,299	74,695
4451	Grocery stores	697,742	8.3	72,680	70,154	71,825	67,795	65,263	72,607	71,586	71,044	67,257	66,663
4453	Beer, wine & liquor stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	5,837	5,970	5,761	5,572	(*)	5,993	5,952	5,831	5,786
446	Health & personal care stores	328,880	4.2	34,335	33,465	33,985	32,541	32,089	34,063	33,906	33,649	32,315	32,611
44611	Pharmacies & drug stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	27,501	27,872	27,288	26,676	(*)	27,807	27,487	26,885	27,055
447	Gasoline stations	644,225	34.4	64,286	61,813	67,977	54,734	51,994	64,094	61,567	63,948	54,408	51,787
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	242,528	7.3	24,987	23,941	26,376	24,366	22,592	26,391	26,396	26,145	25,609	25,264
44811	Men's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)
44812	Women's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	3,195	3,266	3,269	3,113	(*)	3,410	3,391	3,356	3,384
44814	Family clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	9,414	10,291	9,785	8,791	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4482	Shoe stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	3,208	4,264	3,064	2,988	(*)	3,525	3,469	3,330	3,339
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	87,061	2.4	8,655	8,999	10,185	8,605	8,566	9,227	9,258	9,335	9,001	8,904
452	General merchandise stores.....	664,366	3.0	70,442	66,088	69,704	69,188	62,955	69,979	70,107	69,558	68,382	67,541
4521	Department stores	104,534	1.8	10,915	10,417	11,552	11,103	10,223	11,311	11,552	11,407	11,492	11,355
4529	Other general merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	55,671	58,152	58,085	52,732	(*)	58,555	58,151	56,890	56,186
45291	Warehouse clubs & supercenters.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	47,480	49,966	49,965	45,212	(*)	50,032	49,668	48,842	48,303
45299	All oth. gen. merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	8,191	8,186	8,120	7,520	(*)	8,523	8,483	8,048	7,883
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	155,482	17.6	16,465	15,892	16,558	14,988	14,230	16,040	15,994	15,934	14,535	14,403
454	Nonstore retailers	1,024,005	12.0	109,571	102,008	107,724	97,978	90,401	111,505	110,224	109,557	99,967	97,674
4541	Elect. shopping & m/o houses	(*)	(*)	(*)	92,262	97,508	88,768	82,234	(*)	99,420	98,195	90,487	88,710
722	Food services & drinking places	849,374	17.5	90,685	87,281	89,313	80,332	76,566	89,521	88,074	87,305	78,449	78,288

(*) Advance estimates are not available for this kind of business.

(NA) Not available (a) Advance estimate (p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(S) Estimate does not meet publication standards because of high sampling variability (coefficient of variation is greater than 30%), poor response quality (total quantity response rate is less than 50%), or other concerns about the estimate's quality.

(1) For a full description of the NAICS codes used in this table, see <<https://www.census.gov/naics/>>.

(2) Estimates are concurrently adjusted for seasonal variation and for holiday and trading day differences, but not for price changes. Concurrent seasonal adjustment uses all available unadjusted estimates as input to the X-13ARIMA-SEATS program. The factors derived from the program are used in calculating all seasonally adjusted estimates shown in this table. Year-to-date seasonally adjusted sales estimates are not tabulated. Adjustment factors and explanatory material can be found on the Internet at <<http://www.census.gov/retail/>>.

(3) Advance estimates are based on early reports obtained from a small sample of firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey (MRTS) sample. All other estimates are from the MRTS sample.

(4) GAFO represents firms which specialize in department store types of merchandise and is comprised of furniture & home furnishings (442), electronics & appliances (443), clothing & accessories (448), sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, and book (451), general merchandise (452), office supply, stationery, and gift stores (4532).

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, November 16, 2022. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 2. Estimated Change in Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS code	Kind of Business	Percent Change ¹					
		Oct. 2022 Advance from --		Sep. 2022 Preliminary from --		Aug. 2022 through Oct. 2022 from --	
		Sep. 2022 (p)	Oct. 2021 (r)	Aug. 2022 (r)	Sep. 2021 (r)	May 2022 through Jul. 2022	Aug. 2021 through Oct. 2021
	Retail & food services,						
	total	1.3	8.3	0.0	8.6	1.2	8.9
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	1.3	9.0	0.1	9.3	1.0	9.5
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	1.0	7.4	0.4	7.7	2.0	7.7
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	0.9	8.0	0.6	8.2	2.0	8.2
	Retail	1.2	7.5	-0.1	8.0	0.9	8.3
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1.3	5.2	-0.3	5.5	1.9	6.0
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers ...	1.5	4.8	-0.5	4.8	1.9	5.5
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	1.1	0.4	-0.9	0.2	0.1	0.8
443	Electronics & appliance stores	-0.3	-12.1	0.0	-8.6	-2.4	-9.6
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	1.1	9.2	-0.2	10.2	2.6	10.2
445	Food & beverage stores.....	1.4	7.6	0.7	7.0	1.8	7.2
4451	Grocery stores	1.4	8.0	0.8	7.4	1.7	7.6
446	Health & personal care stores	0.5	5.4	0.8	4.0	1.6	4.0
447	Gasoline stations	4.1	17.8	-3.7	18.9	-6.6	21.5
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	0.0	3.1	1.0	4.5	1.6	4.2
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	-0.3	2.5	-0.8	4.0	0.7	4.2
452	General merchandise stores.....	-0.2	2.3	0.8	3.8	1.3	3.2
4521	Department stores	-2.1	-1.6	1.3	1.7	0.3	0.2
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	0.3	10.4	0.4	11.0	0.9	11.5
454	Nonstore retailers	1.2	11.5	0.6	12.8	2.6	12.4
722	Food services & drinking places	1.6	14.1	0.9	12.5	3.3	13.1

(p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(1) Estimates shown in this table are derived from adjusted estimates provided in Table 1 of this report.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, November 16, 2022. Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability.

Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at

<www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 3. Estimated Measures of Sampling Variability and Revision to Advance Estimates Oct. 2022

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey and Monthly Retail Trade Survey)

NAICS Code	Kind of Business	Median CV ⁽¹⁾ for Current Mo. (%)	Median standard error ⁽¹⁾ for Percent change			Revision for month-to-month change ⁽²⁾	
			Previous Mo. to Current Mo.	Previous Qtr. to Current Qtr.	Current Mo. to same Mo. Last Yr.	Average revision	Median absolute revision
441 4411, 4412 442 443 444 445 4451 446 447 448 451 452 4521 453 454 722	Retail & food services, total	0.8	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	0.9	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.2
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.9	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.3
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	1.0	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.2	0.3
	Retail, total	0.7	0.3	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.3
	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1.6	0.9	0.4	1.2	0.1	0.4
	Auto & other motor veh. dealers	1.7	1.0	0.4	1.2	0.1	0.5
	Furniture & home furn. stores.....	2.6	1.0	0.7	1.6	0.1	0.7
	Electronics & appliance stores	2.1	0.6	0.5	0.9	-0.3	0.7
	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	2.6	0.7	0.5	1.1	0.0	0.4
	Food & beverage stores.....	0.6	0.1	0.2	0.4	0.1	0.2
	Grocery stores	0.7	0.1	0.2	0.5	0.1	0.3
	Health & personal care stores	3.4	0.4	0.3	0.9	0.7	0.8
	Gasoline stations	1.2	0.3	0.3	0.9	0.2	1.1
	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	2.5	0.9	0.7	1.5	0.2	0.4
	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	2.7	0.7	0.9	1.6	0.0	0.2
	General merchandise stores.....	1.1	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.1	0.2
	Department stores	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1
	Miscellaneous store retailers	5.2	3.0	1.4	3.3	-0.3	2.3
	Nonstore retailers	1.5	0.5	0.4	0.7	0.4	1.2
	Food services & drinking places	3.8	0.8	0.6	1.8	0.4	0.4

(1) Estimated measures of sampling variability are based on estimates not adjusted for seasonal variation or holiday or trading day variation. Medians are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

(2) These columns provide measures of the difference between the advance-to-preliminary and preliminary-to-final estimates of month-to-month change for the same pair of months as measured by the Advance sample and MRTS sample. The average and median revisions are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, November 16, 2022. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.